A case study of possible UI improvements

Description

Get familiar with trivago's products keeping in consideration our different platforms: desktop, mobile web, and apps.
- Focusing on UI, propose 2-3 improvements to the current experience applicable for all our platforms
- Please explain why your idea is improving the product.

My process

1.
Checking Desktop, mobile web and app starting from main page and taking note
half hour

2.
Opening a Figma page to develop ideas further more
4 hours

3.
Gather all together and finalization +_+
1 hours

4.
Review and adjustment
half hour

Intro

After setting my **time management plan**, I began exploring Trivago's platforms. While the UI wasn't as pleasant as I expected, the platform's consistency was good. **I imagined myself as different types of customers:** a poor student seeking cheap travel, a luxury traveler, a professional user needing efficient tools, and a disabled user facing challenges.
During this exploration, I encountered **usability issues**, **poor information architecture**, and **unclear** UX writing, especially on the **result pages**. Therefore, **my first suggested improvement** focuses on enhancing the components and layout of these pages.
Additionally, while using Trivago, I thought of **an alternative flow to help users to choose** the most suitable accommodation option. This idea arose from the overwhelming number of **similar options**, making it harder to decide. This new flow will be **my second suggested improvement**.
At the end I noted Some points and questions that could lead to possible adjustments in different parts, which I decided not to pursue in this case study.
The UI design in this case study focuses on desktop, I envision applying these changes to mobile; however, I haven't had enough time for that here.

Tools

Notion | Figma | Figma plugin

1st suggestion: result view on Desktop

Goals

Initial assumptions
- **Trivago is a platform**, not the main service provider
- Core value is to **help user find the best suitable option possible**
- Business makes money **by referring travelers** to hotel website

Suggested analysis process

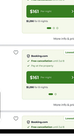
- **Usability test**: by testing different types of users with different background we can increase our understanding about how people actually use Trivago as a tool.
- **Analytics tools** like GA4, heap or even BI tools like Metabase could help us to tack user behavior and increase our knowledge about success full rate of different flows or features. The requirement for this one is to set **right metrics** to be able to correctly count users.

Possible issues

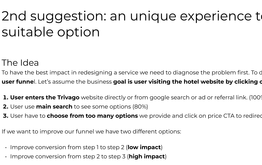
let's assume that we did analysis process, compiled the data and here are the results:
1. **Map part of the result view could be tricky to use** for some users. The act of scrolling will zoom in/out when your mouse is on the map view, and changing the view on map part will reload the results. It means that if someone whats to **scroll and do it by mistake on the map view part** (which is almost 40% of my screen), **the results will change** based on the new view of the map.
2. When **users hover on a card** on the list, it will show **repetitive info on map view** part which will not help user decide.
3. **Hotel cards could be confusing** for some users, specially because there is **a lot of different function** defined **on different part** of the card.

Solutions

1. **An alternative for map view**: The "view on map" **sticky button at the bottom of the page**. It will still show where is the hotel card that user is hovered on but much more simple. **clicking on it will open full map view.**

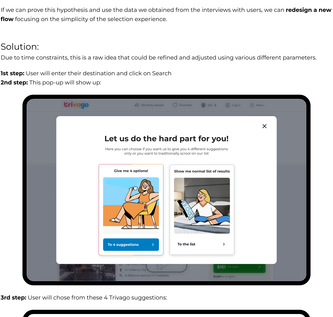


2. **KISS the hotel cards:** Keep the hotel card as simple as possible by removing any **unnecessary data** and revise the **architect of information**



Final UI:

Designed on 1280 * 832 frame



2nd suggestion: an unique experience to find best suitable option

The Idea

To have the best impact in redesigning a service we need to diagnose the problem first. To do that, we need to **draw user funnel**. Let's assume the business **goal is user visiting the hotel website by clicking on price CTA.**

1. **User enters the Trivago** website directly or from google search or ad or referral link. (100%)
2. User use **main search** to see some options (80%)
3. User have to **choose from too many options** we provide and click on price CTA to redirect to hotel website (10%)

If we want to improve our funnel we have two different options:

- Improve conversion from step 1 to step 2 (**low impact**)
- Improve conversion from step 2 to step 3 (**high impact**)

What makes it **hard for users to choose**? I think it's because of the "**Paradox of choice**". The paradox of choice is a phenomenon where an abundance of options can counterintuitively lead to less happiness, less satisfaction, and hamper the ability to make a decision.

How can we prove this theory?

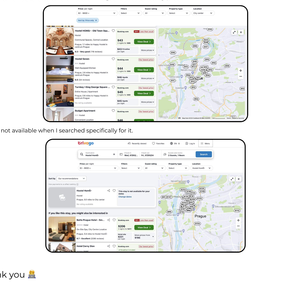
1. Monitor user behavior on **analytics tools**
2. **Interview** and asking questions from users who abandoned flow.

If we can prove this hypothesis and use the data we obtained from the interviews with users, we can **redesign a new flow** focusing on the simplicity of the selection experience.

Solution:

Due to time constraints, this is a raw idea that could be refined and adjusted using various different parameters.

1st step: User will enter their destination and click on Search
2nd step: This pop-up will show up:



3rd step: User will chose from these 4 Trivago suggestions:

Some Points and Questions that could lead us to possible adjustments in different parts

How could we make better experience in sorting feature?

What is "recommended" defined as in Trivago? Does "How payment to us affects ranking?" adequately explain the content inside? What is the reason for combining recommendations with other parameters? We could measure the usefulness of this combination by analyzing the number of successful bookings made through these options and counting drops in each of them.
Assuming our main goal is to increase bookings through Trivago, if the combination of recommendations with other sorting options results in fewer completed bookings, I suggest keeping it more simple and removing them. we can only offering four sorting parameters (or do what is done in mobile app in the desktop as well):
- Recommendation
- Price
- Distance
- Rating

What if we add a comparing feature for people who wants to dig in?

We recognize that probably this flow may hurt some people who have decision making problems. But if we consider applying the idea of offering simple version of the results (2nd suggestion), maybe we can also consider people who are more capable of making decisions. This feature should be easily accessible but not prominently placed, ensuring it is available for those who need it without overwhelming others.

I found a bug that I want to report =)

Hostel homer is available on the list of all Prague results sorted by price:

But it's not available when I searched specifically for it.

Thank you 🙇